

Title: New player here, what is "wave management" and how much of it do I need to know?

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

I hear stuff like "freezing" and "crashing" and "stacking" waves, but I don't really know what that physically entails, or what it even looks like.

I'm a Jungle player, so I can't imagine I'd need to know **everything** about it, but as a player on the field, I'll probably be participating in it, even if I don't realize I am.

I don't want to be the person who fucks up something delicate without even noticing.

PS: (When I said I'm new I mean really new, like, level 23, haven't played in multiple years, never even seen ranked mode)

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 25]

Ok well the very first thing you need to know is that if there's more minions in one wave then it'll push the other wave back as more minions = more minion damage, meaning minions on the smaller wave die faster.

With that being said, the best time to gank is when the minion waves are both located on YOUR side of the lane. For example in bot lane, the waves will have met past the half point but are not yet getting hit by the tower. This is the ideal wave state for ganks because enemy laners will probably be pushed up trying to get the wave to crash, (hitting the minions as fast as possible) as standing on the enemy side of the lane is a dangerous position to be in. Now if you see your bot lane struggling

to get their wave under the enemy tower and the minion waves are stuck in enemy territory, you as a jungler might want to help your team shove and safely recall. This is important information for the top lane, as laners can get fucked for the whole entire landing phase depending on how they manage their minions.

Crashing means to get your ENTIRE minion wave under the enemy tower so that the tower can hit and kill all the minions. Sometimes a laner will shove and then think that they crashed their wave, but the tower kills the melee creeps and then the ranged ones are just standing there waving their arms and chilling. That is bad. The wave can potentially freeze there. If you recall what I said earlier, the minion wave with more minions will kill the smaller wave faster and will result in the bigger wave pushing towards the enemy tower. People can use this to their advantage by purposefully having a smaller minion wave on THEIR SIDE of the lane. Because their minion wave is smaller, their minions will die faster, but because your minions are closer to the base (minions leave the nexus at the same time for both teams by the way) your minions will arrive to lane first and will start smacking the enemy minions, meaning that your wave will never completely die and will just freeze in place. That is why laners will use freezing to take advantage of a weaker opponent or to force their opposing laner into a vulnerable position for a gank. If you notice that your laner has set up a freeze and the enemy laner is disrespecting the freeze by walking up and hitting the minions, you can start running up there because that's a free ass kill (make sure the enemy is killable, i.e. if your teammate is half hp and enemy is full hp it might be tough). On the flip side if you notice that your teammate is struggling due to an enemy freeze, help them shove their wave so that they can recall.

Stacking waves is used when slow pushing. Obviously hitting the enemy minions as fast as possible will result in the enemy wave dying really fast and your minions running towards the enemy tower. That's fast pushing. When you last hit the minions, The wave stays at a somewhat neutral state (meets in the middle) but will be pushing towards enemy tower at a slightly slow pace (due to you

killing the minions instead of them dying naturally). So when you last hit the minions, the next wave will come and will 'stack' with the old wave and wave will continue to slowly push towards the enemy tower. Eventually the huge wave will reach the enemy tower and will crash, resulting in the enemy laner being stuck under tower and needing to cs all the creeps. If your laner is healthy enough, this is a dive opportunity (killing enemy under their own tower). If your laner is not healthy then it's a great time for them to recall. If your teammate is the one farming a stacked wave, they probably don't want to help with a gank attempt, because if it doesn't work out then they just lost a shit ton of minion gold. Therefore unless it's a guarantee free kill, just let them farm.

Anyways as a new player don't worry too much about all the minute details because you'll probably also be playing with new players who have no idea how waves work. Most players just smack the minions without thinking and don't care where the minions end up.

Also as a jungler the most you're gonna do is look at the minion wave, figure out where it's gonna go, and then decide if it's a good time to gank or not. Wave management is up to the laners and is not your job (although you can certainly help).

Edited: format so it's easier to read

[Comment 2 | Score: 5]

Im too lazy to read what the other guy said but ill do tldr. You don't need to know what any of that is in low ranks because no one knows how to gain leads from it or how to use the.

the wave pushes when there's more minions on one side.

Freezing is making the wave be in place in front of your tower by having more enemy minions than yours so it won't start pushing against enemy. You can farm easier, make enemy lose minions. Etc.

stacking is when you slow push by last hitting and "stack" multiple waves (2 or 3) and then try to, take plates, Cheater recall (recalling and walking back to lane without any minions dying), look to dive the opponent under tower so he loses it all.

slow pushing you do when you're stacking waves it's pushing the wave slow as possible by last hitting.

crashing is making sure your wave goes under the enemy turret so enemy cannot freeze it and then it will bounce back and start slow pushing into you.

Last hitting= hitting the minions at the very last possible moment.

[Comment 3 | Score: 3]

If you're a new player and a jungler, don't even worry about wave management lol.

[Comment 4 | Score: 2]

as jungle, nothing. play nocturne, press r, get gold 4 and then watch yt vids abt it

[Comment 5 | Score: 2]

As a jg it's still beneficial to know wave states because it can impact your decision to gank or help out your laners, for example if your laner needs to crash their wave it puts them at a risky position, if enemy is slow pushing you can warp around to gank, if enemy wave is about to crash you can hold

to freeze it for your laner, stuff like that.